

User Guide - Time Tracking & General Working Hours

 Deutsche Version: [ANLEITUNG.md](#)

Access link: 🖱️ <https://timetracking.insightarcs.com>

This quick guide is aimed at **employees**. It explains the two core functions for daily use:

1. **Time Tracking** – project-related recording of work performed
2. **General Working Hours** – legally required attendance tracking (clock in / clock out)

 Additional functions for **project managers** and **administrators** will follow in upcoming releases and will be added here.

What is the solution designed for?

Insight Arcs Time Tracking is a web-based solution that lets teams record their working hours in a way that is **legally compliant and project-accurate**. It combines two levels:

- **Project-based time tracking:** How much time was spent on which project and which task – the basis for reporting, invoicing (billable / non-billable) and project forecasts.
- **General working hours (attendance):** The legally required documentation of daily working time under the German Working Hours Act (**ArbZG**) – regardless of whether you are currently booking on a project.

All data is stored **GDPR-compliant in Germany** and archived in an **audit-proof, GoBD-compliant** manner (10-year retention, tamper-evident verification chain). The interface is bilingual (German / English) – the chosen language is stored permanently per user.

Login & Navigation

1. Open <https://timetracking.insightarcs.com> in your browser.
 2. Log in with your credentials.
 3. Use the main menu (sidebar on desktop, navigation bar at the bottom on mobile) to reach:
 - **“Time Tracker”** → project-based recording
 - **“Working Hours”** → attendance / clock in-clock out
 4. The **language** (German/English) can be switched at the top right of the header – the setting is saved.
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1. Time Tracking (project-based)

Menu item: **“Time Tracker”**

There are **two recording methods**. Switch between them at the top of the view:

a) Live Timer 🕒 (for ongoing activities)

Ideal when you start a task **now** and want the time to run live.

1. Select the **“Live Timer”** tab.
2. Choose the **project** and optionally the **task**.
3. Enter a short **description** of the activity.
4. Click **“Start Timer”** ▶ – the clock runs.
5. For interruptions: **“Pause”** ⏸ (resume later) – paused time is not counted.
6. To finish: **“Stop & Save”** ◻ – the entry is booked.

The timer keeps running in the background, even if you reload the page.

b) Manual Time Entry 🖋️ (for forgotten / past days)

Ideal for **adding** times that were not stopped live.

1. Select the **“Manual Time Entry”** tab (labelled “Past Days”).
2. Choose the **date**.
3. Choose the **project** and optionally the **task**.
4. Enter a **description**.
5. Enter the **start time** and **end time**.
6. If needed, enter the **break (min)** – it is deducted from working time.
7. Click **“Save Entry”**.

Billable / Non-billable 🇪🇺

For every entry, the **€ symbol** determines whether the time is billable:

- **€ (green) = billable** (invoiced to the client)
- **€ struck through (grey) = non-billable** (e.g. internal activity)

The default comes from the project (client project = billable, internal project = non-billable) but can be adjusted per entry. Hover over the symbol to see the current status in your language.

Approval workflow (if enabled for a project)

If **approval is required** for a project, your entries first receive the status:

- **Draft** → not yet submitted
- **Submitted** → waiting for approval by the project manager
- **Approved** → reviewed and booked

If no approval requirement is set, entries are booked directly as approved.

2. General Working Hours (attendance)

Menu item: **“Working Hours”**

This view is for the **legally required working time recording (ArbZG)**. It is **independent of project bookings** and relevant whenever you

- **do not work on a project** (e.g. general tasks, meetings, administration), or
- **are not assigned to a project full-time** and need to document your daily attendance.

Day Types and Absences

Each day can now be assigned to one of **five types**:

Type	Icon	Description	Time fields
Regular Working Time	grey	Normal working day	Clock in, clock out, break required
Vacation	 blue	Vacation day	Optional: only for half-day
Sick Leave	 orange	Sick day	Optional: only for half-day
Special Leave	 purple	Special leave (e.g. moving, wedding)	Optional: only for half-day
Parental Leave	 green	Parental leave	No time fields

Full-day absence vs. half-day

- **Full-day absence:** Select the appropriate day type (e.g. "Vacation") – the time fields (clock in/out/break) are automatically hidden. The day counts as fully absent.
- **Half-day:** Activate the **"Half Day"** checkbox – the time fields remain visible so you can record the worked half-day (e.g. vacation in the morning, worked in the afternoon).

Target time calculation: crediting vs. neutralization

The day type affects how the day is included in the **monthly target hours**:

- **Regular Working Time:** Counts towards target hours, worked hours are recorded.
- **Vacation / Sick Leave / Special Leave:** The day is **credited** – it counts towards the target AND is considered fulfilled (credited to your time account). Your balance remains neutral.
- **Full day:** full daily target hours (e.g. 8 hours) are credited
- **Half day:** half of daily target hours (e.g. 4 hours) are credited, worked hours are additionally recorded
- **Parental Leave:** The day is **neutralized** – it is completely removed from the target hours (neither target nor actual). The monthly target hours are reduced accordingly.

Example: 20 target workdays in the month, including 3 days vacation and 2 days parental leave:

- Target hours remain at 20 days (vacation counts)
- Vacation is credited with $3 \times 8h = 24h$
- Effective target hours are reduced to 18 days (–2 days parental leave)

The **metric cards** at the top show you:

- **Target Hours Month** – including number of credited days and parental leave days

- **Actual Hours Month** – including credited hours
- **Overtime Balance**

Recording a working day

How to record a working day:

1. Choose the **date**.
2. Select the **type** of day (default: “Regular Working Time”).
3. For absences: optionally activate **“Half Day”**.
4. For regular work or half-day: enter **Clock In** (start time), **Clock Out** (end time), **Break (min)**.
5. Optional: add a **note** (e.g. “Home Office” or location).
6. Click **+ Save** to save the day.

Editing daily entries

Each saved day can be **edited** retrospectively (except in locked periods):

1. In the table, click **“Edit”**  for the day you want to change.
2. The entry is loaded into the form – **everything** can be corrected (date, type, times, note).
3. Make the desired changes.
4. Click **“Save”** or **“Cancel”** to discard the edit.

All corrections are logged in the **GoBD-compliant audit log**.

Working days table

In the table below you see for each day:

- **Date**
 - **Type** (colored badge with icon; “· ½” for half-days)
 - **Clock In – Clock Out** (for full-day absences: “—”)
 - **Break Time**
 - **Gross Time** (total attendance)
 - **Net Working Time** (gross time minus break)
 - **Note**
 - **Actions** (Edit button)
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Time Tracking vs. General Working Hours - the difference

	Time Tracking	General Working Hours
Purpose	What did I work on?	When was I present?
Reference	Project + task	No project reference
Basis for	Reporting, invoicing, forecast	Legal obligation (ArbZG)
Billable?	Yes (€ billable / non-billable)	Not relevant
When to use?	For project work	When not (fully) on a project

 **Tip:** The two levels complement each other. Project times show the content of your work, general working hours document your attendance – together they form a complete, legally compliant record.

Frequently Asked Questions (brief)

- **Do I have to set the language again at every login?** No. The last chosen language is stored in your user profile and loaded automatically at your next login.
- **What if I forgot the timer?** Use **Manual Time Entry** to add the day afterwards.
- **Are breaks deducted?** Yes – both project-based time tracking and general working hours deduct the break from net working time.